

COSMIC DOUBT



*life... is strength. this is not to be contested, it seems
logical enough: you live, you affect your world. but is
it what *you* need? you are... different, inside*

*this doll lives and has strength of a sort: it lost its
parents to plague, its partner to war but it
persevered. its farm has prospered, its name is
respected and its children are fed and safe – it lived
as it thought it should... and now it is dead*

*its land will be divided, its children will move on and
it will be forgotten. it lived a "good" life, but it had
no power: it was a slave to death*

*i wonder if *you* are destined to be forgotten... will
your life fade in the shadow of greater beings? you
are born of murder, the very essence of that which
takes life – you have power, if you wish it*

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the deepest philosophies of mankind all swim in the infinite sea of **cosmic doubt**, yet for all the wisdom we extract from its depths humanity seems unable to see the sea through the waters

as far as you know, nothing is more cosmic than cosmic doubt. you can find it lurking around in the most granular levels of your intellectual thought, fully engrained in whatever ideas you have, no matter how stupid or how deep

the basic version of cosmic doubt is the idea that there's always doubt: nothing is certain, perfect, absolute, etc. it could reasonably be called other things or phrased in different ways but the main idea is that all knowledge, ideas & claims are subject to doubt, all morality, interpretations & opinions to subjectivity, all measurements to uncertainty, all theories to imperfection & incompleteness, and so on
– you either get it or you don't

the hippie bullshit version of cosmic doubt is the singularity of reason, where to believe it is to doubt it

and vice-versa. it's *the* unfalsifiable claim, the rock made by god that's so big not even he can lift it, the noise in every signal you can't get rid of, the permanent glitch in your intellectual software, the unescapable matrix, etc

A BRIEF HISTORY OF DOUBT

cosmic doubt is littered throughout history – here's some examples. first, some quick ones that go back 2000 years:

Heraclitus doubting the idea of permanency
no man ever steps in the same river twice

Zeno doubting the ideas of time, space & motion
if a task has infinitely many milestones, then how can you even do anything?
(50% of the way, 75%, 99%, 99.9999%, etc)

Plutarch doubting the idea of identity
*if you eventually replace all the original boards of a
ship over time, is it still the same ship?*

Zhuangzi doubting the idea of a divine creator
物物者非物
(literally *thing-thinger not thing*)

GOTAMA'S BUDDY

the hindu philosopher Gotama wrote an entire
chapter about doubt in the *Nyaya Sutras*. Gotama
says doubt is more fundamental than reason, which I
guess makes sense, since we wouldn't need reason
if there was no doubt

he also has a fictional argument with buddy who
claims true knowledge isn't real. Gotama says
buddy's claim makes no sense because he's
contradicting himself by claiming it as if it's true
knowledge

buddy argues back and says it makes no sense the other way around because of the fact that we justify knowledge with things like theories, practical demonstrations and so on: these become new kinds of knowledge that we have to figure out new justification for, and so if all we do is justify our knowledge with other knowledge, then true knowledge is an endless quest that you can never finish

essentially, buddy realized what kids already knew – you can keep asking *why?* forever

PLATO'S CAVE

a famous western-world example of cosmic doubt is the *allegory of the cave*, where Plato doubts our perception of reality by thinking about shadows. the idea is better explained by Austin Powers

in *The Spy Who Shagged Me*, Austin & Ms. Shagwell set up camp on a remote island in their chase for Dr. Evil. as they unpack supplies for their mission, Dr.

Evil's guards approach their tent and watch in horror and disgust as the shadows from the tent show Ms.

Shagwell pulling a wide range of things out of Austin's asshole before hammering a tennis racket into it, all with complementary dialogue

the joke is hilarious because of how clearly the tent & shadows fuck with the reality of the situation and make the guards think the duo are sick fucks

Plato was saying that maybe we're like Dr. Evil's guards and we can't see reality as it truly is: our senses are like tents and our experiences are like imperfect shadows of reality. but unlike the guards, we can't just storm the tent to see what's up: the shadows fuck with reality in a way that we can't beat

hippies and other people desperate to feel spiritual like to argue that meditation and/or psychedelic drugs prove otherwise, but if you tell them about cosmic doubt and they think about it really hard they might realize that they're just tripping the fuck out

DESCARTES' DEMON

in the renaissance era a guy named Descartes doubted his own existence. what if some demon was trying to trick him into thinking he was real?

according to popular legend, after some thought he concluded *i think, therefore i am* and called it a day, apparently never realizing that he could doubt his sense of self or his understanding of what it means to think

BERKELEY'S TREE

a priest named George Berkeley doubted that things could even exist outside of perception, saying trees in a garden only exist while you're there to look at them

after hundreds of years of thinking about it, people eventually repackaged his idea as a simple question:
if a tree falls in the forest and nobody's there to hear it, does it make a sound?

QUINE'S RABBIT

the philosopher WVO Quine had this idea called *indeterminacy of translation* where he argued that translations between languages aren't right or wrong in any kind of cosmic theoretical way, just practical to whatever degree in a way that's subjective to us

that might sound like a really obvious case of cosmic doubt, but Quine decided not to be an arrogant dick and thought really hard about it

he thought up an example where you run into a group of natives in a foreign land who speak a language you've never heard before. they point at a white rabbit and yell *gavagai!*, and you wanna know what the hell that means

it might seem obvious that it translates to rabbit, but Quine realized that you can imagine endless hypothetical-but-technically-possible scenarios that make the translation wrong

how do you know gavagai means rabbit and not *white* rabbit? what if the rabbits in the area spread diseases and gavagai is a special word that means *oh shit watch out, this one's got rabbitpox*? what if they just pointed in a random direction and yelled, and the rabbit happened to be there by coincidence?

this is kind of like Gotama's buddy, but instead of just asking *why*, you conjure up doubt by thinking of scenarios that make the translation wrong. different translations are more reasonable than others in different scenarios and some scenarios are more likely than others, but the point is that they all cause doubt

any translation you come up with, no matter how practical, can be doubted by some hypothetical context – even if everyone agrees on your translation, it's not that it's some kind of cosmic truth, it's just a good enough guess

Quine's rabbit essentially boils down to cosmic doubt
saying that your knowledge is always incomplete:
you can never be sure you have *all* the relevant
context or info needed to make a perfect translation,
and so the idea that a translation even *can* be perfect
or correct makes no sense – translation is
indeterminate

WORKIN OR JERKIN?

before we do more thinking, let's think a bit about
thinkin

you might think cosmic doubt is just for armchair
philosophers who sit around mentally jerking off all
day. this is generally true among philosophers, but it
turns out lots of normalfolk are mentally jerkin on at
least a semi-regular basis, and not just with cosmic
doubt. the thing about cosmic doubt is that
sometimes it actually shows up while you're workin
and suddenly you realize it's not just jerkin

the line between workin and jerkin is blurry at times,
but in principle, when you engage in philosophy,
spirituality or intellectuality, it's important to ask
yourself, *are you workin or are you jerkin?*

MENTAL WORK ETHIC

workin means engaging with a good mental work
ethic – you're authentic in your search for
understanding and committed to doing whatever's
needed to analyze and maximize the quality of your
knowledge, whatever the fuck that even means

jerkin is the opposite, and means engaging with a
bad mental work ethic – you're inauthentic and
uncommitted to quality, and use cheap & deep
wisdom and pseudointellectual bullshit to hide it,
usually for status reasons

it's important to understand that workin and jerkin
only apply to people who engage. Plato's teacher
Socrates came to realize this as he found that
normalfolk were generally wiser than people of status

because they weren't claiming knowledge (i.e. engaging) – the normalfolk weren't workin, but at least they weren't jerkin either

Plato also understood the importance of workin and not jerkin when he wrote ***let no man ignorant of geometry enter*** above the entrance to his school. the geometry people of his time weren't necessarily philosophers, but they were most definitely workin and not jerkin – they *really* wanted to understand shapes and circles and lines and shit, so they thought about it a lot & worked really fuckin hard to figure shit out. Plato respected that, and figured that any good philosopher should keep an eye out for hard workin people and see what they're up to

i think Plato had the right idea – if you wanna be a workinfolk you gotta constantly seek out and learn about other workinfolks' workins

GETTING CAUGHT

Plato didn't always follow his own rules, and at one point he got caught jerkin

he was trying to figure out a good way to define a human and suggested something like *a featherless two-legged animal*. a guy named Diogenes heard that, went and plucked a chicken and brought it to Plato's school saying *behold, Plato's man!* Plato apparently covered himself up and changed his definition

relatively speaking, i'd say Plato took his embarrassment with grace, because generally speaking, people fucking hate getting caught jerkin

jerkin can be good for the soul in small doses, but excessive jerkin can lead you to dark places, and when you get caught jerkin in public it makes you think twice about where and when you do it

it's a good thing, but man do people ever fucking
hate getting caught jerkin – just ask Socrates, who
publicly exposed high society's jerkin and promptly
got sentenced to death

COSMIC JERKIN

the problem is that cosmic doubt applies to all of this
workin and jerkin stuff, and so you can never truly be
sure that you're not jerkin, no matter how much it
feels like you're workin

as much as Socrates exposed societal jerkin, he was
jerkin too, going off about all kinds of stupid shit like
being on a mission from the one true god, knowledge
being the only good and ignorance being the only evil

i once told a friend about Quine's rabbit. he didn't
care much for philosophy, so i explained it as: *i don't
know what you're saying, you don't know what i'm
saying, nobody knows what the fuck anybody is
saying so we should all just shut the fuck up*

after all, everything is technically a translation right?
even if you speak the same language as your buddy,
you still have to interpret and translate what they
mean by their words

Quine didn't actually say we should all shut the fuck
up, i just threw that in there for flavour. but in theory,
you could take that very seriously and act on it

Diogenes, the guy who brought Plato a plucked
man-chicken, seems to be the first and only guy in all
of history who ever did that

Diogenes pulled some legendary shit. not a mental
gymnastics guy, Diogenes caught a glimpse of
cosmic jerkin and was enlightened. instead of sitting
around talkin the talk (jerkin), he took to the streets of
Athens and walked the walk, committing himself to
shameless poverty and living through his actions. he
defied taboos, (physically) jerked off in public, shit on
the temples of the gods, embarrassed the wise and
disregarded all status

upon hearing of Zeno's paradoxes and his claim that motion was impossible Diogenes said nothing, but simply stood up and walked, thereby disproving the claim. he carried a lantern around in broad daylight, and when asked why, he said he was looking for an honest man. he spit in the face of a rich man who invited him in, saying there was no cheaper place to spit in his house. he casually dismissed none other than Alexander the Great, the most powerful man of his time, who laid himself at Diogenes' feet and offered anything within his power

schizoid is the old punk

FAITH

human history has unknowingly crowned cosmic doubt as the defacto unbeaten final boss in the game of philosophy, and the closest we ever come to beating it is when we *pretend* not to play. we have a very special name for this strategy – *faith*

faith is the functional ignorance of cosmic doubt, a
kind of jedi magic

MACE HINDU

Gotama's buddy argued that true knowledge isn't
real because it's an infinite goose chase for
justification. Gotama's response was nothing short of
hilarious – he basically just says *these are not the
droids you're looking for* and calls it a day. he says:

*it is not so. the means of right knowledge are
established like the illumination of a lamp*

THE GAME

someone once told me about *the game*. apparently:

- you can't win the game
- you can't not play the game
- if you think about the game, you lose the game
- if you lose the game, you have to say that you lost
the game out loud

i instantly beat the game with jedi magic. more impressively, i've seen someone beat it with cosmic doubt: she just denied ever thinking about it. if you think about it, she probably just didn't wanna admit she was using jedi magic

the thing is that cosmic doubt *is* actually *the* game you can't not play, and that you can't win. unlike the *the game* game though, you don't lose when you think about it, you lose when you lose faith – even blind faith is better than none

BLIND FAITH

most people just never encounter or think about cosmic doubt explicitly, and so they show their faith blindly, without thinking. this is a natural thing to do, but it also reinforces itself naturally: humanity's blind faith often manifests as religion, systems of social compliance that unintentionally obscure cosmic doubt with pressures and incentives such as shame and status. impressively, the most aggressive

religious folk often unknowingly weaponize cosmic
doubt against the enemies of their faith

this is why a lot of people will say they're spiritual,
but not religious: they see the social compliance
bullshit part of a religion and say fuck that, i just
wanna explore my faiths

indeed, people are faithful with respect to their
various gods, spirits, objects, concepts and ideas
and accordingly build religions around them:
christianity, islam, buddhism, animism, ghosts,
healing crystals, balance, harmony, communism,
fascism, intersectionality, the scientific method, the
law of attraction, etc

and their faith isn't misplaced – for better or worse,
religion gets shit done. what do priests, academics,
conspiracy theorists, hippies, progressives and
fascists have in common? at the end of the day,
they're all clerics of the same faith, avoiding the
same thing that would entirely fuck up their systems
and stop them from getting shit done

Karl Marx once said religion is the opium of the masses, which was a pretty fair call considering the masses took his philosophy, put it in their pipes and took a big fat fucking hit of marxism

in his wisdom, Marx was essentially saying that most people operate on blind faith, and there's nothing wrong with that on its own. when Descartes said *i think, therefore i am*, he acted in blind faith when he took his sense of identity for granted, the same thing pretty much everybody else does for obvious reasons

FAITH WITHIN FAITH

people tend to think of religions as isolated systems of mystical faith, separate from beliefs about day-to-day life, but the reality is that religions are more like a nine-layer onion of faiths built on simpler faiths. the unseen onion at the core of all religions is the *onion of reason*, which is roughly seven layers of

subconscious primordial faiths that functionally
answer the following big stupid questions:

1. does anything really exist?
yes (something's out there)
2. is there anything to know?
yes (the truth is out there)
3. what does it even mean to know something?
dunno (but it works so shut the fuck up)
4. how can you even know stuff to begin with?
it just happens (learning is magic)
5. are there different things & things to know?
yes (they/them)
6. what makes different things different?
the stuff you can know about them (their essence/identity)
7. how do you go from knowing stuff to knowing other
stuff?
you just do (we call it inference)

pretty much all the typical religions we know assume these things, but we usually take it as obvious and don't think about it. the 4th layer was Gotama's answer to his buddy

a trained person might recognize these faiths as the core of logic (objects/things, properties/predicates, knowledge/truth values and inference rules), but that's not important here

what's important is that these layers are so basic that under normal circumstances it's pretty much impossible for a normal person to fuck this up and turn it into jerkin – it's the layers that come after where the jerkin starts to creep in

ok, so we live in a world with stuff in it, there's stuff to know about stuff, you *can* know stuff about stuff and you can *use* what you know about stuff to know *more* stuff about stuff. the problem is: where do you start?

the first part of the answer is that you need to start *somewhere*. but then this begs the question: since there's a bunch of things to see & do & know, why start with any one thing over any other thing? one smartass answer people take a liking to is: *why not start with everything?*

ok, what is there to know about everything? what is the *essence of everything?* people might not ask this question outright (or even think about things in this way), but they sure as hell love to answer it, and this is where the jerkin starts

they give answers like god(s), spirits, manna, sacred geometry, universal consciousness, grand unified theories, oppression and even nothingness itself. some retards will even talk about things like cosmic doubt, as if that makes any sense

this 8th layer of primordial faith – the god layer – is the point where religions split off from each other, and it's interesting because it shows that even if people don't think about it consciously, they seem to

understand deep down that the very thing they unknowingly put on a pedestal (reason) crashes under simple examination, and that in some sense they have to abandon it to start using it

the god layer gives rise to morality, the 9th layer, which is some bullshit that tells us how we *should* act based on whatever bullshit we came up with on the 8th layer. morality is what lets us make decisions and get shit done: it helps us cope & carry on with the fact that reason is an illusion at its core (despite being useful), and for this reason Marx probably should have said that ***morality is the opium of the masses***

the full nine-layer onion is the *primordial onion of humanity*. it was known to the ethiopian philosopher Zera Yacob, who wrote that reason was god's light which could not be doubted, and that it allows us to know truth and morality

whether or not people know or want to admit it, everybody has some variation of this onion: if you

think of yourself as a car, the logic layers are the engine & all the other shit under the hood, the god layer is the world you drive around in and the morality layer is your compass that tells you where the fuck you're going (hence the term *moral compass*)

religions as we commonly know them are the god & morality layers: they're essentially road trip guides for the world, and people, being people, don't think about what's going on under the hood of their car until it starts dying

A SLIPPERY SLOPE

like opium, blind morality can help you ease your pain in the short term, but it can lead you down a slippery & painful slope in the long term. one of the problems is that it often turns into some combination of jerkin, rigid thinking, tribalism and cultish behaviour. easy examples of this are bible thumpers, culture war larpers (both lefties & rightos), libertarian purists and other religious fundamentalists who think

that if everybody was just like them the world would
be great, or at least not doomed

people like this get pissed when others aren't like
them because they think it's stopping their world
from being a better place. this leads to tribal bullshit,
and different tribalists deal with being pissed in
different ways. the more aggressive ones declare
enemies, wage war, protest, lobby, publicly sulk, etc,
while the less aggressive ones just smile and go
about their business, thinking of you as a lower life
form to eventually be processed, educated and
controlled by the system when the chosen people
take over. but then this behaviour pisses other
people off, and in their rage a lot of those other
people end up thinking the solution to tribal bullshit is
to join a tribe

tribes always have one foot in the door of cultish
morality, which helps keep their people in line – all
good cult leaders know that people have an easier
time doing the mental gymnastics needed to buy in,
and not catch themselves jerkin, if they think their

religion does the greatest good or fights the greatest evil (sometimes they can do even more gymnastics and end up doing some serious shit)

modern tribes usually also have their other foot in the door of cultish science. people nowadays generally understand that morality is subjective because there's so much information out there, and so the cult leader's solution to this is to bury the first layer of bullshit morality under another layer of bullshit morality (science), dazzling their followers with bullshit studies, statistics and metrics or bullshit interpretations of legit ones. pretending you know and/or care about data, statistics and the scientific method helps build trust, since science is the new world religion that echoes the praises of reason and brings us technological comfort & happiness

regardless of the faith, religion, tribe or cult, they're all embedded in the same great religion of humanity, the religion of reason. none of the whack jobs who claim they can do supernatural shit – channel god's healing, speak to the dead, use psychic abilities or

whatever the fuck – ever go and chop off their own hand thinking it can just be magically grown back through supernatural shit, because deep down they don't worship supernatural shit, they worship reason, even if they only ever seem to use it when it's convenient for them. it's convenient for them to live, so they don't go freejumping off cliffs because their blind faith in reason says that jumping means falling, falling means dying, and dying is bad

there's lots of practical reasons why people take reason for granted, but the main one – even if they don't know it – is that survival, and even existence itself on a technical level, is a war against the environment. being social, cooperating & combining our efforts has been a successful survival strategy for us thanks to reason's computing abilities that we could kinda sorta get the hang of, and so in our kinda sorta understanding of reason we formed a religion around it to get shit done, and the result of our success is society. most peoples' war against the environment is mostly (or at least partly) social now, and so even if people don't understand reason itself,

what they do understand is that they have to get with
the religion's program or get the fuck out

apparently you learn this if you're a smart angry
comedian who takes acid. funny enough, in the midst
of writing all this shit i ended up on some ungodly
meth head part of the internet, watching some video
that included this bit from Bill Hicks that i'd never
heard before:

*the world is like a ride at an amusement park, and
when you choose to go on it you think it's real
because that's how powerful our minds are, and the
ride goes up and down and around and around it's
got thrills and chills and it's brightly coloured and it's
very loud and it's fun, for a while. some people have
been on the ride for a long time and they question: is
this real, or is this just a ride? and other people have
remembered, and they come back to us and they say
hey, don't worry, don't be afraid, ever, because... this
is just a ride. and *we*... kill those people: "shut him
up! we have a lot invested in this ride, shut him up!*

*look at my furrows of worry! look at my big bank
account, and my family! this *has* to be real..."*

the bit ends with a bunch of John Lennon hippie
jerkin about how it's all just a choice (man), and how
if we just choose love over fear and feed the poor
and give em the educations the world will be a better
place, no doubt. Bill died of cancer in 1994 and i'm
sure he'd be thrilled to be resurrected from the dead
30 years later to see those same ideas be turned into
a bullshit religion that spread through society's
institutions harder & faster than the christian bullshit
he hated ever did

CONSCIOUS FAITH & HEURISTICS

in contrast to blind faith, conscious & deliberate faith
is a *heuristic method*, a systematic way of making
decisions despite limited time, resources and
information. most people don't know about
heuristics, but they're an important part of getting
shit done in the new & confusing world of AI, among
other things

the systematic part of heuristics means it's conscious and not blind by definition, but as a cheap technicality you might as well call blind faith *subconscious heuristics*, because either way, if you question people far enough about their reasons for doing shit you'll eventually hit a wall where you get responses like *i dunno, it seemed like a good idea, i went with my gut, i just said fuck it*

this is because when you try to dig down to the bottom of reason you find a void of information – cosmic doubt – and so all knowledge and decision making reduces to faith & heuristics. for sanity reasons most people don't dig this far, but those who do find the ultimate heuristic: conscious faith in the direct face of cosmic doubt

GOOD FAITH & BAD FAITH

the question of good faith vs bad faith is more or less a question of workin vs jerkin. some people use their faith in a good way, for workin – to better understand

things, to be diplomatic, to improve relationships and move things along for the better. others use their faith in a bad way, for jerkin – to dishonestly pursue petty whims, advance political agendas, avoid accountability and gain status

sometimes a bunch of people all act in good faith, but have or end up with different pictures of reality and start fighting over whose picture is more right, which degenerates into a confusing world of bad faith

Julia Galef saw this confusion in what she calls the *graph of despair*, data showing that political polarization increases as people get better with numbers. this happens because at the end of the day, math, science and statistics – no matter how useful – are heuristic systems, and at the end of the day all you've got are lies, damned lies and heuristics

TECHNICAL FAITH

unlike *the game*, there are some games that are annoying to play but we play them anyways because they're useful, the two easiest examples being math and logic

most people kinda sorta assume that math and logic are perfect but it turns out cosmic doubt lurks there too, and you'll find that some of the most fundamental shit in math is actually just Gotama-style jedi magic, rules that counter instances of cosmic doubt by saying *fuck you, our power is absolute* in some specific context

a good example of this involves giving ourselves the power to choose shit so that we can start somewhere. the band Rush did a song about choosing shit, and how you can't not choose shit because you have to choose not to choose shit. ok, so let's say you choose to choose shit. they give you a few examples of shit you *can* choose, so how do you choose which shit to choose?

usually we choose shit systematically, like the biggest shit or the baddest shit. but sometimes we don't give a shit, or doubt about how to choose shit creeps in and we just need to choose *some* shit – an unsystematic & arbitrary choice, grounded in nothing

sometimes it's liberating to say *i don't have to justify shit*: indeed, faith can set you free. wouldn't it be so liberating if we had this shit built into our reasoning systems so we could systematically make unsystematic choices about shit?

turns out mathematicians gave themselves infinite systematic power to unsystematically choose shit for hundreds of years without even noticing. eventually a guy named Zermelo came along and hard coded that shit into math. he called it the *axiom of choice*, and it turned out to be some good shit. later on people even proved that sometimes magic is the *only* way to choose shit (well-orderings of the real numbers, for the nerds)

but it turns out jedi magic has its limits: different jedi magics are incompatible, leaving you in a highly technical game of whack-a-mole. for example, in addition to choosing shit we also like to measure shit, so we made a theory about doing that, and it turns out that infinite power to choose shit means you can't measure everything: you get weird magical unmeasurable shit in your system that lets you do other weird magical shit, like break a ball into pieces and then rearrange the pieces into 2 exact copies of the original ball (the *Banach-Tarski paradox*)

either way, even if all the jedi magic worked, Gotama's buddy still gets the last laugh – there's still infinite shit to use it on, and so unless you have infinite time on your hands the only way to beat buddy is to turn to the dark side and use the sith magic where you nuke all meaning and just say *my system does whatever the fuck it wants and doesn't have to justify fuck all*

never go full sith

DOUBT IN THE REAL WORLD

there are many flavours of doubt in the real world:
here are 13 examples you might encounter in the
wild. ***if you find your knickers knotting up as you
read through some of the commentary, take a
break and read the next section on doubt &
society.*** if you're still pissed after that, eat shit

WHALESDOUBT (KIDS)

kids apparently know about cosmic doubt without
needing to be taught

i remember when i was 6 or 7 my friend's sister (3 or
4 years old) said she was smarter than me. i was
pretty damn sure i was better at math than her, so i
asked her what 3 times 3 was. she said she wasn't
gonna tell – i asked why? because you don't know?
she argued back that i was trying to trick her into
giving me the answer because *i* didn't know, and that
she wasn't gonna tell me

i was onto her game, so i tried to prove i knew the answer without saying it by showing that i could multiply other numbers. i gave a bunch of examples and each time she just said *that's right* with a pretentious & authoritative voice. I pressed her again for the answer and she just said the same thing – *i'm not telling you, you're just not saying it cause you don't know*

duh, of course i hadn't proven myself – as far as she could tell maybe i memorized all those other examples but still didn't know 3 times 3. so i baited her with a wrong answer like 8 or some shit – she bit, and i claimed victory as i revealed my trickery. she just claimed reverse trickery, saying that she just took the bait to see if i really knew

to this day i have no proof of her bluff, the clever bitch

WOLFSDOUBT (HISTORY)

a lot of what we know is from history, and by history i mean any kind of lasting man-made record like text, audio recordings and other historical evidence like old pottery or whatever. since we learn about history from historical records, we generally understand that no matter how long ago or how recent, if there's no record of what happened and we weren't there, we have no fucking idea what happened

for some people this means *anything* could have happened. this understanding was the start of a fantastically canadian conversation over beers in the parking lot with a history-loving friend

i smoked my government hash and listened as he explained how the historical records about syrup and honey making don't go back very far, and reasoned that syrup might actually pre-date honey

i was skeptical – i said there's no fuckin way our ancestors were boiling syrup in containers before

they found a beehive in a tree or on the ground or
some shit

he told me i gotta think about it in terms of the
technology of the times, and that you could probably
think of a deer licking sapwater from a tree as syrup
in the time before humans existed

our other buddy, who'd quietly been drinking his beer
throughout the conversation, pissed himself laughing
as i conceded that licking trees probably came
before finding beehives

THORSDOUBT (SAMPLING BIAS)

sometimes we take a historical record like a bunch of
experimental data and process it into a new record of
research results by doing statistics, which is subject
to limitations and doubt

one night i was driving a buddy and one of his friends
home from a concert we went to. the two of them
were having some good intellectual conversation,

going over lots of stuff, when buddy's friend brought up some study with some survey result that was relevant to the conversation

buddy said something like *yeah, but that's just the people who RESPONDED*, suggesting that whatever issue they were talking about was actually way bigger than what the science makes it out to be

under the hood, buddy was talking about what statistics people call *sampling bias*, which is a fancy statistics people way of saying that not having all the data can lead you to wrong conclusions because you might have missed some really important shit. it *is* a legitimate thing, but we do work to solve that problem

he sounded upset when i told him, in a polite and roundabout way, to quantify the sampling bias or kick rocks

INCOMPEDOUBT (PERFECTION)

incompedoubt is one of the most annoying forms of doubt that everyone knows & hates: if something you did isn't absolutely perfect, is it that things are never perfect but you put in a reasonable level of effort given what you know & can do, or is it because you're an incompetent fucking retard?

in the west we know this as being a *backseat driver*, and it's absolutely fucking insufferable

sometimes this happens by accident – on that level this is called *hindsight bias*, where you forget what it's like not to know something when you pass judgment. professors and dungeon masters can be guilty of this when designing their courses or tabletop adventures (thinking they know how their students/players think & approach things)

but backseat drivers are the worst pieces of shit because they act like the path to perfection is common sense whenever they're not the ones doing

the work (while generally being the type to cry when they're the ones who have to do it)

a lot of people do this, but girlfriends, wives, bosses, management & other authority figures are typical culprits, since it's a tool to bitch and nag and get you to do shit

two classic workplace scenarios are the tradeoff traps between quantity vs quality and efficiency vs reliability, where management tells you to prioritize one over the other: you do as they say, and then when the other naturally suffers as a result, management turns around & lectures you about how the other one is important, as if you're some fucking idiot kid who doesn't know any better

backseat driving is also common in the canadian legal system, where the self-defense laws say you can only use a "reasonable" amount of force when defending yourself

in the heat of a deadly self-defense situation you have limited time to assess how severe a threat is and you sure as fuck aren't gonna give your attacker the benefit of the doubt for the sake of their survival, especially if *they're* the one intruding on *your* territory. but apparently that doesn't stop a self-righteous judge or jury from giving it to them anyways & saying that you could've done better in the heat of the moment

one of the stupidest cases of this (among many others) happened in 2019, when a man from manitoba literally woke up to being stabbed in his sleep at home but miraculously got the knife from the guy and stabbed him 13 times, killing him: he got five years in prison for manslaughter (i.e. imperfect self-defense) and was lectured that while he had a right to self-defense he went beyond what was necessary to defend himself, as if surviving a stabbing in your sleep is just some fucking walk in the park where all you gotta do is scare the guy off and call it a good scrap

THEORYDOUBT (EVERYTHING)

theorydoubt is basically where you invoke cosmic doubt in its general form, saying that nothing is certain or that everything is subjective or whatever (*it's just a theory, man*). it's mostly used by hippies for jerkin, but normalfolk also bust it out on occasion

sometimes people find themselves in a conversation about really complicated and/or sophisticated stuff that they know nothing about, and that makes them feel scared. nothing makes physics go away like pointing out that it's technically just a theory, and that it's not really the real thing

people generally avoid this when arguing seriously about stuff, because we usually take at least *some* level of justification for granted when we do that – using theorydoubt in that case makes you look like a retard who takes cheap stabs at other peoples' ideas because you have nothing to back up your own

INTERPREDOUBT (INTERPRETATION)

interpretedoubt is a way of using theorydoubt that makes it seem slightly less like bullshit: instead of saying *it's just a theory, man*, you're saying *that's just your interpretation, man*. in bad faith, this adds a layer of fake reasoning to theorydoubt it by making it seem like you're doubting *something* (an interpretation) rather than everything, even though you can interpret everything as being an interpretation

after all, we don't always understand what we hear, say or read – that's why we ask things like *what does that mean?* or *what's your point?* when people explain shit to us, which creates a need for interpretation. anyone can interpret shit, so who's right?

it's basically the same conclusion that Quine came to – you might blindly or consciously have faith that some interpretations are better than others (there's a saying, *all models are wrong, but some models are*

useful), but at the end of the day cosmic doubt says nobody's *objectively* right. this lets us avoid the consequences of using cheap generic theorydoubt because it sounds more reasonable

Karl Marx pulled some shit like this when he said that philosophers have only *interpreted* the world so far but that the point is to change it, giving him a cheap excuse to spew activist bullshit. and let me tell you, there's nothing in the fucking world more annoying than a woman breathing down your neck and nagging you to *do something* while you're trying to figure shit out, especially if she's got that white-girl-penguin-noise voice

this isn't to say that interpretedoubt is always in bad faith. like theorydoubt, it's technically true, and in certain contexts it's relevant. that's why we have phrases like *one man's terrorist is another man's freedom fighter* or *one man's trash is another man's treasure*, because at least nowadays people generally accept that morality and value are subjective interpretations at the nuts-and-bolts level

a hilarious example of interpretedoubt comes from the *whatever* podcast, where they bring bimbos on the show and make money by exposing their jerkin, which serves as jerkin material for non-workin losermen to cope with the consequences of their moral opium addiction (see ghettodoubt below)

in one episode of the podcast, masterdebater Andrew Wilson, apparently unaware of theorydoubt or the techdoubt discussed below, claims to one of the bimbos that there's only one way to do logic.

bimbo just rawdogs him with snarky white girl interpretedoubt: *ok, if that's how YOU want to interpret logic then...*

Andrew denies her response, saying *no, there's only one way to interpret logic, just like math*. in this case bimbo's technically right and he's technically wrong, but the point i'm sure he wanted to make is that is that we have faith in math due to its overwhelming practical use in the real world, and so bimbo's interpretedoubt is in bad faith

INFODOUBT (INCOMPLETENESS)

infodoubt is the practical form of interpredoubt where you add layers of *actual* reason by imagining something that causes doubt in a specific interpretation (like Quine did with his rabbit), rather than just saying there's doubt in *every* interpretation. its practicality makes it so common that most cases of cosmic doubt are either straight infodoubt or a variation of infodoubt

infodoubt is stronger than interpredoubt because you get to be creative and use your imagination. as always, this is incredibly useful when used in good faith: for example, scientists use infodoubt for practical purposes all the time. after all, research costs time & money and we don't have infinite resources to gather infinite data and do infinitely careful processing

scientific studies generally end with the authors talking about what they can & can't conclude from

their data and what kinds of hidden data might support or challenge their ideas – this is essentially the main idea behind science, where we do our best to poke holes in our theories so that we can come up with better ones

in the *whatever* example above with Andrew Wilson & bimbo, Andrew follows up on his point about there only being one interpretation of math & logic: he asks her if $2+2$ can ever *not* equal 4

as bimbo struggles, another girl chimes in with the most basic infodoubt, wondering if $2+2$ could not equal 4 if there's *missing information in the middle* (her exact words), which causes the guys a lot of frustration

the thing is that unlike bimbo, othergirl was actually using cosmic doubt in good faith: even if it seems dumb, and even though it's the least imaginative version of infodoubt, she was genuinely curious about missing information and what that could mean

othergirl is the hero of this story – the manchildren who watch the podcast for validation would do well to take note of this & not discourage a woman's good faith, and more women should be like othergirl

infodoubt is one of the most common bad faith ways of arguing because as long as you have a good imagination you can create the illusion that you're workin even though you're jerkin, giving you a cheap, low-effort way of refuting someone's well thought out interpretation of things

in arguments and debates we interpret each others' ideas and use our own or others' interpretations as reference when we make our case – the idea is that we interpret each others' interpretations in good faith and try to refine & eventually agree on them so we can push our ideas in a good direction. the problem is that arguments and debates tend to be (or become) competitive instead of cooperative, which leads to bad faith

debates aren't the only source of bad faith infodoubt though. sometimes people are quick to take advantage of information that's just naturally hard to get or hard to explain. the easiest example of this is a business's overhead costs

overhead is notoriously hard even for the business owner to see (hence the name overhead), nevermind put a dollar value to, and as business owners know all too well, customers love to take advantage of this

shitty customers only see the materials & labour, and so they might start to nitpick about why things cost so much and try to argue for lower costs, potentially threatening bad reviews or non-payment for labour the workers have already done

scientists' use infodoubt in bad faith on occasion too, to avoid or discredit certain conclusions in the data. sometimes it's blatant ignorance, where they just don't want to challenge their own beliefs, but othertimes it's a survival tactic, where publishing

certain results could be risky if they challenge a social culture that has a lot of aggressive followers

the easiest modern example of an aggressive social culture is woke, the dominant social culture of western women and nearly all major western institutions, whose followers can be immensely aggressive – opinions or results that go against woke can ruin your reputation and/or end your career, regardless of whether or not they're correct or well thought out, and so you have to tread carefully

for example, imagine a study where the data shows higher rates of mental health problems for white people than the other races. woke says whites have it made in the shade while the others are oppressed, so that shouldn't be the case. even if the authors don't buy into woke, they might fear backlash & suggest hidden information that reverses the more obvious narrative, saying that the result suggests other races lack equal access to proper care or have a culture that stigmatizes getting help. these are much harder to prove or disprove, which makes the

narrative reversal harder to refute and covers the scientists' asses (it's almost like this is a real example or something)

woke has an infodoubt thing where people from group A have no right to talk about or deny any claims made by people from group B because A-groupers don't know what it's like to be B-groupers (they can't understand B-groupers' *lived experiences*). this could potentially be done in good faith, but in practice it's pretty much always bad faith: B-groupers get to say whatever the fuck they want about A-groupers as long as group B is "more oppressed" according to the ideology, which has an unspoken demographic hierarchy

this is just an extension of an old narcissists' trick. in public they wear suffering as a badge of honour for status, whether real or not, and when confronted over bad behaviour they claim victimhood through their suffering & use the classic *DARVO* strategy to avoid accountability (deny, attack, reverse role of victim & offender): the idea is that they get to do

whatever they fuck they want, and you get to sit
there & eat shit like the bitch you are

in general, the way woke spreads through academia
and the world at large is an obnoxious example of
infodoubt: their scholars build up a big fat fucking
mountain of bullshit literature backed by a big fat
fucking system of bullshit credentials
(gender/race/women's/queer studies degrees, etc)
that they can use to discredit you when you question
their jerkin

how can you *truly* understand what they do if you
haven't read all the literature? even if you happen to
be really well versed and you can keep up with all the
bullshit jargon, do you *really* have the necessary
frame of mind to understand what it means if you
haven't been through a Ph. D. program in it?

BUSYDOUBT (VERIFICATION)

busydoubt is a special infodoubt move that indirectly
weaponizes doubt by exploiting the fact that people

don't have time to check & verify every bit of info
they hear, see or read and have to resort to heuristics
to make decisions

busydoubt is why a lot of bullshit spreads, because
you can often make something sound reasonable to
the point of common sense when it fact it's total
bullshit

the military theorist Jason Lowery wrote about the
reason for this in his recent thesis *Softwar* (which the
US military immediately took off the shelves). he
noticed that you can exploit the most common
senses of all: never say no to a good opportunity,
and don't risk death if you don't have to

this makes us more open to suggestions of
potentially big opportunities or threats: we tend to
give those the benefit of the doubt and act
accordingly

Jason calls the people who exploit this *god-kings*,
giving egyptian pharaohs as a primary example: the

pharaoh can flex his power & claim godhood, and if his people don't know any better and/or have no power to test the claim then they may as well believe him. Jason describes the general idea well:

a god-king exploits a population through their belief system. the 4-step process: describe a desired state the population wants, describe a gateway to reach it, position yourself as the gatekeeper, and increase adoption of the belief system

in this sense, politics and marketing are kind of like god-king arts. woke serves as an example for politics: the people want kumbaya, so woke scholars claim their affirmative action or equity, diversity & inclusion programs as a gateway to that and position themselves as priests of progress that truly understand the rituals needed to move forward as a society

with marketing, one of the best examples of a god-king is Dogbert from *Dilbert*. in one episode of the cartoon, Dogbert exploits office workers by

drumming up hysteria & taking advantage: he writes a book saying that the common problems office workers experience (sore back, stress from management, etc) are actually symptoms of a newly discovered disease called chronic cubicle syndrome

Dilbert thinks this is a stupid idea because Dogbert has no scientific evidence. Dogbert tells him anecdotal evidence (the fact that most office workers have those symptoms) is good enough, because practically nobody verifies scientific evidence for themselves: they rely on media reports to tell them it exists because “they’re busy” and end up gullibly believing stupid shit. chronic cubicle syndrome becomes a craze and Dogbert makes a killing selling solutions to the problem he created

women know about being god-queens. a woman once preached to me her values of equal contribution in a relationship. i told her that, while great in theory, how this usually works in practice is that the woman gets to do all the accounting, and if the man asks for

a say in the matter she tells him to get fucked (she had nothing further to say on the matter)

another way women commonly use busydoubt against their partners – not sure about lesbians, but definitely straight women – is by exploiting the fact that people are too busy to retain old or irrelevant info: one of the oldest and most common grievances men have is when their woman brings up old or irrelevant shit in the heat of an argument, which then complicates things and leads to the argument going nowhere with no resolution. show any guy who's been in a long-term relationship with women Ari Matti's joke about the gay couple arguing and they're gonna laugh their ass off

make no mistake, this is busydoubt, the way it works is just really subtle: it's a sophisticated way of spamming someone with inputs to make them crash (computer hackers call this kind of thing a denial-of-service or *DoS attack*). men know all about women nagging, whining, bitching & complaining, but it seems like they're too stupid to figure out DoS

attacks – if they did at one point it's been long forgotten, but maybe the struggles of older times just made violence an insanely cheap response compared to figuring women out

the high level summary of how it works is that today the average western woman's man wants and is culturally trained to do two key things: use good faith reason to figure out solutions to problems, and take his woman's input at face value & on good faith, giving her the benefit of the doubt

this deadly combination is what the woman exploits – it lets her spam him with inputs while being convincing enough to keep him thinking that reasoning is a gateway to a solution. the man can't see the forest through the trees, so he ends up getting overloaded with context to reason through and crashing

this works because when she brings up old and/or irrelevant shit, her man can't remember the details of the old shit very well (if at all) or can't figure out how

the irrelevant shit relates to the relevant shit (because it doesn't). when he admits to this in good faith, she can then gatekeep the argument by claiming that she *can* remember (whether truthfully, mistakenly or dishonestly)

from this position she can cast doubt on his understanding of things & drag things on, and as things drag on the man loses track of all the context and his honesty lets her continue to doubt & spam inputs until he finally crashes and submits. he never ends up clueing in because he always gives her the benefit of the doubt when he can't verify her integrity (i.e. he can't prove whether or not she's not arguing in good faith). as Jason says:

you don't need an army to control a population. you just need a belief system they can't verify and a convincing story. all it takes is one persuasive narrative to bend an entire population to your will

well played, ladies

however, women aren't the only group who use the busydoubt DoS attack combo. it's actually a generic social power play that the more powerful use against the less powerful, because more power means more capacity to generate doubt (Jason seems to have figured this out too). other people who do this include narcissists, politicians & political interest groups (including woke), and it turns out there are a number of other similarities between these groups

of course, people love to look at these similarities & jump to conclusions that are completely wrong, and it doesn't help that the word narcissist gets tossed around nowadays with the same level of misunderstanding as fascism (manosphere losers/right wing culture war retards conclude that women/wokes are narcissists deep down)

HIPPIEDOUBT (CAUSATION)

one way to use infodoubt is to imagine a chain of cause and effect from one thing to another when there's a lot of confusion or unknown variables in the

middle. the most basic bitch example of this is
hippiedoubt, when there's no reasoning at all but it
still seems reasonable

the easiest example is when hippies talk about
manifestation: if you just think positive thoughts, then
you'll manifest positive things! if you think about
money, you'll make money! as long as there's some
theoretical path from point A to point B you're good,
and you can even make a whole bullshit religion out
of it like the law of attraction

in good faith and good circumstances we remove
doubt from the question: the path from point A to
point B is well thought out and maybe even detailed
enough to make good predictions. Darwin could have
just read a book about monkeys, made a *hippiedoubt*
theory of evolution and called it a day, but he went
way beyond that and did a lot of work to turn that
hippiedoubt into science

but circumstances aren't always good. sometimes
there's just too much noise and the connections

between the dots are vague, but that's ok: you acknowledge the noise and the vagueness in good faith and keep an eye out for ways to make the connections better. at the end of the day you don't always have time to process everything before making decisions, so hippiedoubt is necessary at times

there probably *are* scientifically well-measured correlations between positive thinking and positive outcomes that were (and still are) key to our survival as a species, even if all the neuroscience and psychology is a mystery. tarot cards can be fun and possibly useful even if you don't believe in mystical magical bullshit: it's still a game of playful & exploratory interpretation, and when you interpret your life circumstances in new ways your brain can fire off in new ways and eventually you'll find solutions to problems (or some bullshit like that)

the problem is that this kind of thinking is easy jerkin for people who want that spiritually and intellectually mature look but don't like workin. hippies are the

typical example of this kind of degeneracy because,
as Hunter S Thompson says, they think they can buy
peace and understanding for 3 bucks a hit.
psychedelics plant the seeds of deep primordial shit
like cosmic doubt in their minds, but when it comes
to putting in hard work to grow those seeds they just
go nah man i just wanna plant em, planted so many
fuckin seeds it's unreal

even though hippies are the low-hanging fruit when it
comes to this (hence the name), bad faith
hippiedoubt is everywhere because it makes it really
easy to dismiss other peoples' problems (or your
own) by chalking everything up to mindset and
saying that all you or someone else has to do is
change their attitude

people everywhere do this kind of lazy shit all the
time, a notable example being emotionally abusive
women saying you don't care about them when you
don't give them what they want. men & women who
are pissed off about dating have copied this one:

both sexes now have the internet phrase *if he/she
wanted to, he/she would*

a more dangerous example of this is in cults, where
members who don't get what they pray for (money,
relief from a stressful situation, etc) might be told
something to the effect of *if you were *truly* faithful,
god would*

JAPDOUBT (CONSIDERATION)

japdoubt is a mix of infodoubt and etiquette. it's sort
of like hippiedoubt, but it revolves around *harm* (a
vague word that involves lots of doubt)

in the west we have a moral rule, the golden rule of
reciprocity that says *do unto others as you would
have others do unto you*. i once read somewhere that
japan has a different moral rule, the unspoken
platinum rule of consideration that more or less says
don't be a fucking nuisance to others or to society.
central to not being a nuisance is *consideration*

consideration is about respecting peoples' sensitivities, i.e. understanding contextual info as to why someone might feel uncomfortable or unsafe or offended or whatever other negative emotion. while there's a common sense idea of how being considerate works, infodoubt lets you imagine infinite scenarios that could lead to negative emotion or "harm", and so in theory you can accuse anyone of causing harm for pretty much anything they say or do

this is why the debate over free speech will be a neverending circlejerk of bullshit: naive ideas are a necessary byproduct of free thought, and naive ideas are sometimes stupid by definition, so free speech gives us a neverending supply of workin & jerkin material for people that are concerned about societal harm

consideration is great in good faith: we get to hold hands, be happy and sing kumbaya together. this makes it ugly in bad faith: publicly accusing someone of being inconsiderate publicly elevates you as someone who's empathetic, sympathetic and

pro-social. these are huge signals of moral superiority, especially among women, and the ability to performatively disguise this kind of social attack as empathy makes it low risk, incentivizing women, narcissists, activists, management and politicians to japdoubt others for status

they also often use japdoubt to avoid accountability by accusing you of harmful negativity and/or insensitivity when you call them out on bullshit

a company i worked for had a system of “personal needs days”, where you could take a day off to take care of some personal shit and work 8 hours of overtime to compensate. their explanation for why we had to work 8 hours instead of the 7 hours & 15 minutes we normally worked was that we don’t get paid for lunch if we’re not there for the day... except we never got paid for lunch in the first place

i brought this up to management, who looked at me like a deer in headlights and gave me the same explanation, insisting it was 8 hours. seeing how

fucking pointless that was, i emailed HR directly and confirmed that it was 7 hours & 15 minutes (the workers were doing extra unpaid labour). management admitted defeat, but told me that the HR people said my email had some “negative undertones” (it wasn’t bad)... i asked her in a nice way if bullshitting people is positive, and she fucked off

these groups also tend to use japdoubt for protection, to maintain a positive emotional bias towards themselves or their affiliated social group(s)

women in particular are really good at this – they call it the *women-are-wonderful effect* – because they have a deeply internalized (but very good) doubt-based tribal understanding of guilt by association: when dealing with people from other tribes you lose the benefit of the doubt if your tribe has a pattern of behaviour that they *perceive* negatively, regardless of whether they’re wrong or you’re an exception to the pattern. not getting the benefit could mean *harm*, so you have to protect your

tribe's reputation to secure the benefit (it works the same way individually too)

one option to protect your tribe's reputation is to spend time & energy with them to fix the perceived negative behaviour and become more tolerable, but other tribes *might* see that as submission or weakness and be more likely to take advantage & cause *harm*. another option is to make it really fucking costly for people to spread ideas about your tribe's general patterns of behaviour if you know they could be considered negative – guess which one these groups do

a common example of this in the feminist west, if not the whole world, is when women tell men not to make generalizations (the classic – *you can't say that about *all* women*)

this one is familiar to men who talk about women in front of women, where you fall into the trap of explaining that there are obviously exceptions to the pattern, and the woman responds with japdoubt:

someone *could* interpret what you said as a universal generalization about *all* women and that could lead to harmful judgment, so you need to be more considerate, walk on eggshells and add endless disclaimers & assurances to anything critical you say about women (if you're clever enough to point out the japdoubt, hopefully you're ready for a DoS attack)

of course, women have no problem making generalizations about men, and never turn down positive generalizations about women: they only pounce on someone if they say something about women that could be interpreted as negative or status-lowering, even if that's not the person's intent, like with pretty much all the commentary here (which will shirley be gettin some japdoubt)

japdoubt is also common among politicians, lobbyists and activists, who say things like *think about the children* or *muh freedoms* or *genocide* when they push their agendas. the general implication is that not getting on board with their programs constitutes harm against society or some

social group you're supposed to be considerate of (commonly women, children, the elderly and racial/sexual/mental minorities). this could be done in good faith but in practice it's almost always performative, toxic & obnoxious, going far beyond what normal people typically consider considerate (some hilarious examples are the viral videos of the woke labour party/NDP conventions in the UK and canada)

in 2017, a relatively unknown woke scholar named Paul Reynolds explored the idea of good faith political japdoubt in his article *Complicity as Political Rhetoric*, where he talks about accusing people of contributing to (being complicit in) “societally harmful” woke-evil systems like capitalism & colonialism. to his **great** credit, he acknowledges that this isn't some simple shit like saying that bystanders contribute to bullying: instead, he points out that it's vague, imprecise, insanely powerful & can be abused to devastating effect, and encourages people to make sure they're workin & not jerkin when

it comes to this level of japedoubt – what a concept (i guess no one got the memo)

MIRRORDOUBT (PSYCHOANALYSIS)

mirrordoubt is when you doubt someone by holding a mirror up to them (so to speak) and questioning their identity and/or intentions and/or self-awareness

the most obvious example of mirrordoubt today is the widespread use of freudian-style bullshit psychoanalysis, where you infodoubt someone's sense of self-awareness by implying that they might have had some significant and/or traumatic experiences in their past, or some unaddressed feelings hidden deep down inside them that make them do the things you do – for example, calling your partner insecure if they accuse you of hitting on someone else (whether or not you're guilty)

i once had to call someone out on some bullshit and in response he asked me if i grew up in a confrontational household, like i needed to reassess

who the problem was in the moment. and i shut that
shit the fuck down right away

the righto pundit Matt Walsh made a documentary
called *What is a Woman?*, which pissed off a lot of
woke lefties because it hilariously showcased a lot of
their gender jerkin and abuse of doubt. when he
interviews a woke professor and asks him what a
woman is, the immediate response he gets is
mirrordoubt: *why are you asking?* i've seen woke
scholars perform this exact trick live too, so it's not
just a thing of the movies

mirrordoubt works by baiting the person into a status
trap where you've established yourself as the
authoritative psychoanalyst and the other person as
the troubled, subordinate psychiatric patient in need
of a diagnosis. from there you give your diagnosis,
typically a combination of stupidity, trauma or bad
intentions – some people jump to this step by using
japdoubt to diagnose their patient as being either
ignorant or supportive of societal harm

in the case with Matt Walsh, my professional diagnosis is that the professor is trying to defend against Matt's questions by using mirrordoubt, to paint him either as a simpleton with poor understanding of gender or a hateful bigot with anti-social motives who's not to be trusted

another example of mirrordoubt is direct psychoessentialism, where you basically just say something like "i know who you *really* are deep down". this is less common due to how retarded it is, but as you'd expect you find it in retarded circles, the most common being the world of *actual* right wing racists like neo-nazis & the KKK, with their stupid racially fundamentalist theories about blacks, jews & other minorities

but as Osho says, the people are also retarded: people love to accuse each other of hiding their *true* motivations, what they're *really* thinking, what they *really* want, what they're *really* like, who they *really* are, and so on – if you haven't seen this in the real world or on the internet then you must have some

deep trauma that blocks out how fucking ignorant
people are

as with all the other cases, mirrordoubt is great in
good faith – psychoessentialism is basically the 6th
layer of the logic onion, and there's a reason Freud
was such an influential psychologist. but of course,
psychoessentially speaking, people are creatures of
war and are always on the lookout for new weapons.
the dating psychologist youtuber Orion Taraban has
noticed this, and frequently talks about the increased
weaponization of psychiatric & therapeutic language
in society

GHETTODOUBT (KEEPIN IT REAL)

in the ghetto, the gangsters, hoodlums and other
ghettofolk who work the streets know damn well that
cosmic doubt applies to integrity, they just know it by
another name – *keepin it real*. i like to call it
ghettodoubt

despite the name, ghettodoubt isn't just found in the ghetto – that's just the most obvious place to name it after because it's the most jungle-like place of society, where you find the highest stakes (your life) and the hungriest people (both literally and figuratively). it's also well understood by people in highly competitive environments like sports, big business and politics

these people are also hungry, but for status – and while they're generally protected from violence (or at least deadly violence, in combat/contact sports), there are still other types of aggression with big consequences. politicians and executive-level employees might slander, gossip about or otherwise stab each other in the back to compete for a position. big companies might kill off their smaller competition with money by underselling them at a loss for a long time until they starve. lobbyists and interest groups pressure governments to legally disadvantage their opponents with legislation. high-level athletes might dishonourably abuse technicalities to win (Sean Avery)

essentially, wherever the people are hungry and the stakes high, the people know about ghettodoubt

normalfolk somewhat understand ghettodoubt in the ghetto context. they generally want to relate so they don't have to feel like a bitch in their relative comfort, but they usually understand it in terms of *the law of the jungle*, which just says strength is king in the jungle where everything's struggling to survive, and that morality doesn't apply. it's appropriate, but the ghettofolks' understanding is much deeper – ghettodoubt is like a social version of the law of the jungle. i like to explain it by saying ***one man's integrity is another man's opportunity***

ghettofolk quickly learn from experience that hungryfolk are hungry for opportunity, not integrity. if you have integrity it just means you submit to moral standards, and morality is meaningless in the face of cosmic doubt – in that case, to have nothing but strong moral integrity just means you're a submissive little bitch, a sucker, easy prey, a walking opportunity

for hungryfolk to take advantage of. in a hungry world with little to no protection against violence, careless integrity can quickly get you robbed, cheated or killed, period, whether the moral ideals you submit to are religious, rational or social in nature

the psychologist/culture war guy Jordan Peterson advises men to be competent & dangerous – this is good advice, and his explanation for it is roughly *integrity without strength is not a virtue*. this is almost keepin it real, except for the need to bring virtue into the equation. this unreal thing of virtue is a prime example of men's primordial jerkin, taking morality as absolute truth and imposing it on everything. he might as well say *strength is moral* and call it a day

the *real* reason Dr. Peterson's advice is good for men is that women have deeply internalized ghettodoubt – **women keep it real**. roughly speaking, long ago when men were "in charge", they built society upon primordial social jerkins – morality and authenticity – which then became the "official" social culture in order to get shit done. women intuitively saw through

the jerkin but accepted morality's status as a status symbol, which has led to them do shit like say they value integrity, empathy and vulnerability but then treat you like a bitch when you show it

keepin it real is also partially what enables women's use of busydoubt DoS attacks: cosmic doubt means that reason & morality are ultimately just belief systems, and so a man who sees moral integrity in reasoning becomes an opportunity for god-kings & god-queens to exploit

men usually experience this individually at a young age but as a collective they don't seem to be able to figure out why it happens. this is partially because men haven't stopped jerkin, but also because they have a culture of "being in control", which often leads them to instinctively but mistakenly ignore subconscious behaviour in their analysis of things (people do this all the time anyways, but male culture makes it worse)

TECHDOUBT (FOUNDATIONS)

mathematicians, computer scientists and physicists in the 1920s and 30s hit the wall of cosmic doubt hard. for most of us it's no big deal, but for people who care about how things work at the most basic & foundational level, *techdoubt* was nothing short of a fucking nightmare

a legendary story of hubris (arrogant pride) in the world of math is when David Hilbert made a big leap of faith and claimed that math is perfect – that it can prove or disprove any claim without contradicting itself. as the story goes, he was jerkin really hard to the idea of proving it and forgot about cosmic doubt as he climaxed, saying something like *there is no ignorabimus... we MUST know... we SHALL know...* unaware that a few days earlier a guy down the hall named Kurt Godel showed that math systems suffer from cosmic doubt

ironically, David Hilbert was a big fan of set theory, the language we now mainly use to do math (but at

his time wasn't fully accepted). he once said *no one shall expel us from the paradise that Cantor has created*, apparently also unaware that Cantor (the guy who invented set theory) used cosmic doubt as his guiding principle, saying:

the absolute can only be acknowledged, but never known, not even approximately known

the oversimplified version of Godel's result (his *incompleteness theorems*) is that math systems have a permanent glitch where some things are unprovable and one of the things they can't prove is that they don't contradict themselves

like agent Mulder, we want to believe that the truth is out there, so contradictory systems are useless to us – at best we're stuck with imperfect proving power and having to have faith that our system doesn't contradict itself & crash somewhere

you can kind of get around this by making new systems to prove previously unprovable stuff, but

Gotama's buddy gets the last laugh and gives you the same imperfect proving power in the new system. while Godel's result was about proving shit, it turns out there were similar results about computability and truth itself (Alan Turing's answer to the *halting problem* and Alfred Tarski's *undefinability theorem*)

in physics, every physicist accepts that cosmic doubt applies to measuring stuff (every measurement has *some* error), but the physicists in the 20s and 30s got a rude wake up call when they discovered quantum mechanics and the insanely weird but insanely accurate picture of reality it painted

one part of this weird picture is *non-locality*, the physics version of Berkeley's tree which says that there's nothing *for us* to see before we look: as far as we can tell, learning is random magic at the microscopic level of reality. if nobody's in the forest then the trees aren't standing or falling or growing or even green: god rolls some cosmic dice the moment you show up to determine how the trees look &

sound, and if there's any more info beyond the dice
it's beyond us (non-local)

this bothered Einstein – his theory of relativity was a theory of *local* cause & effect (how energy ripples through space & time), an objective reality of things to see. it was a huge success because it described gravity so well, and so he figured that locality was at the core of physics. he called quantum non-locality *spooky action at a distance*, and went on to say that *god does not play dice with the universe*

he went to his grave trying to disprove non-locality, and later on in 1970 John Bell & colleagues would finally disprove locality experimentally, ruling in favour of quantum mechanics (*Bell's theorem*). that being said, relativity is still the most practical description of gravity we have, and locality is the only thing we've been able to disprove about it so far

DOUBT & SOCIETY

you might be thinking to yourself, ok great: there's doubt, people use it & argue with it in different ways, and philosophers & other smart people get fucked by it. but what's beyond that? cosmic doubt doesn't tell us where we are, how we got here or where we're going, so at the end of the day its useless for us as a society... well you're dead fucking wrong

if you're curious as to why then buckle the fuck up and keep reading. it might be useful, but ultimately it's just theoretical bullshit and you can probably just skip it

but if you're serious about a deeper understanding, or a moralistic person who believes that people are good or evil, or one of those political people that likes to act indignant, get their panties in a bunch & fly into a rage about shit then holy shit is this section ever for you

SOCIAL WARFARE

when people hear about cosmic doubt they tend to look for the practical benefits of using it in good faith. in that case, the benefits are generally meaningless to people in day-to-day life: good faith cosmic doubt is mostly scientific or philosophical, used in a humble and/or serious way to think about the practical limits of our understanding

for the average fella in the modern world, the real-world benefit of understanding cosmic doubt comes from knowing how it's used & abused in bad faith: it helps you understand social warfare, where cosmic doubt plays a huge role. if you stop & listen to people and hear their arguing, you'll often find that the core of the argument revolves around who gets the benefit (or detriment) of the doubt. and since there's always doubt, there's always something at stake

bad faith cosmic doubt is used in all kinds of ways by all kinds of people at all levels of society. they use it

in passive ways to avoid the intensity of workin
and/or hide their lack of knowledge/sophistication, or
they use it in aggressive ways to gaslight, avoid
accountability, sow distrust & defend bullshit ideas
when you challenge them intellectually. what makes
this so effective in is the fact that cosmic doubt is so
effective in good faith – it's *technically* correct and in
many ways relevant, which makes it a trojan horse for
the bad faith user to sneak bullshit into an argument
or idea

POLITICS

in today's western world, where people love to drag
others into the social war of political bullshit, it would
help to know that so many of society's
overcomplicated debates about rights and
responsibilities basically boil down to who gets the
benefit/detriment of the doubt in a given situation: if
you get the benefit of the doubt it's a right, and if you
get the detriment of the doubt, it's a responsibility

in the less-complicated part of the abortion debate –
ignoring extreme cases involving things like rape,
severe birth defects or heavy risks to the mother's life
– the doubt is about the cost-benefit analysis of a
woman terminating an otherwise healthy pregnancy.
the pro-choice people give women the benefit of the
doubt, saying it's their right to abort because
sometimes the benefit outweighs the cost (she's not
ready or can't afford it or whatever). the pro-life
people give women the detriment of the doubt,
saying it's their responsibility to be diligent with
getting pregnant because the cost of terminating
always outweighs the benefit (life is sacred or
whatever)

when it comes to freedom of speech, the doubt
surrounds the cost-benefit analysis of being able to
say whatever the fuck you want. cosmic doubt is a
big factor here, because people love jerkin over the
abstract idea of *societal harm*: a man flapping his
gums in hamilton could cause fascism in toronto, so
do we let him flap?

when it comes to stupid shit like this, people generally get the benefit or the detriment of the doubt depending on whether they're with or against the dominant social culture of their society's institutions: if you get with the program, you get the benefit – if you say fuck the system, you get the detriment

a recent example from the woke-dominated western world is when a woke protester (likely white, judging by his voice) called a black ICE agent ***a fucking house nigger working for the KKK*** with zero social consequences. in almost any other case, saying nigger aggressively & with the hard r like that – even if you're not white – comes with widespread backlash, regardless of nuance like if you quoted someone else or used it in historical context. but in this case, ICE are the bad guys for woke, so the protester gets the benefit of the doubt (the logic is roughly ICE = KKK = whiteness)

the woke-before-wokeness professor Herbert Marcuse hard coded this idea specifically for wokeness in his 1965 essay *Repressive Tolerance*, a

masterpiece of bullshit word saladry where he claims that the idea of tolerance is perverted by society because we sometimes tolerate injustice for the sake of cultural stability (the status quo). he saw left wing activism as the engine of progress that'll lead us to *true* democracy & pure universal tolerance, and came to the conclusion that lefties should get the benefit of the doubt while rightos get the detriment:

liberating tolerance, then, would mean intolerance against movements from the right and toleration of movements from the left. as to the scope of this tolerance and intolerance: ... it would extend to the stage of action as well as of discussion and propaganda, of deed as well as of word

so in other words, lefties get to propagandize & do/talk about whatever the fuck they want, and rightos can eat shit. any non-tribalistic & decently rational person who looks at this seriously will see this for the blatant authoritarian bullshit it is, but what they may not realize is that at the individual & small tribe level this kind of thing is common sense: when

in doubt, friends get the benefit, enemies get the detriment and if there's doubt as to their loyalty you gotta choose carefully. it's a social stability mechanism that helps you & your tribe survive by making it costly for other people & their tribes to threaten or attack you. Bambino knows it best:

three days after my escape from the penitentiary in yuma i saw a man following me. he wasn't after me or nothing, we were just going the same way... but i didn't know that, so i shot him

at the scale of large multicultural societies like the modern world, cultures function just like tribes: people, ideas and actions that support the culture get the benefit of the doubt, otherwise they get the detriment. it's a social stability mechanism that helps the culture survive by making it costly for people to publicly criticize or attack it

CULTURE, POWER & PARANOIA

even though the basic social stability mechanism is the same at all scales, the risks are much bigger at the larger scales because of the interplay between power & paranoia

the first part of the problem, which schizophrenics know all too well, is that paranoia can *a/ways* be rationalized. this is because cosmic doubt applies to appearances & intentions: as we like to say, looks can be deceiving, so there's never a foolproof guarantee that someone isn't out to get you

someone's apparent love and generosity could just be part of a cunning plan to lure you into letting down your guard so they can somehow fuck you over in the future, like the witch from *Hansel and Gretel* luring kids in with fun & candy to fatten them up and eat them later. we have a word for people that justify paranoia in that regard: *sociopaths*

basically, cosmic doubt + warfare says that you can
accuse anyone of being a sociopath and that you
can interpret anything as a threat, attack or act of
war: trusting people always carries *some* risk, and if
you can't handle that then the only option is
maximum paranoia, where everyone gets the
detriment of the doubt

the second part of the problem is that tribes, cultures
and societies face potential threats from within, and
as they grow and command more & more power they
become more & more incentivized to direct more &
more paranoia inward (domestic policy)

noiamaxxing is tempting at the individual level
because of the fact that it's very rational & practical
in some cases, like Bambino shooting the guy behind
him (having just escaped from prison), or if you
happen to find yourself alone & unprotected in the
hood at night

but at the tribal level, a small tribe has less power to
fight against the environment and other tribes,

making both the tribe and its people very valuable to each other. internal conflict can spell disaster for the tribe, so their collective paranoia is mainly directed outwards (foreign policy)

but then as society grows bigger & bigger, culture becomes more & more of a problem: as a culture becomes more & more dominant in a society it becomes more & more engrained in society's institutions and commands more & more societal power, to the point where one person's power is just a drop in the bucket by comparison

at that point, the potential benefit of a new ally is much lower than the potential risk of a new enemy on average: a random ally barely helps maintain cultural dominance, but a random enemy could start a countercultural revolution and overwhelm the the status quo. this gives the dominant culture incentive to be inwardly paranoid, especially if it has its external threats and resource management under control (or feels like it does)

however, just because the dominant culture has incentive to be paranoid doesn't mean it will be – it depends on who's running the show, how much the culture feels threatened, and so on. but if it *does* become paranoid, then it's also incentivized to be brutal, because naturally, if the cost-to-benefit ratio of something's existence is too high on average then it's a threat, and threats need to be disposed of. that's why we study viruses & bacteria and do controversial shit like gain-of-function research

in other words, when the dominant culture becomes really powerful, the average person becomes disposable to it, and if it becomes paranoid, the system is highly incentivized to dispose of dissenters in order to survive (which is no bueno)

Hilary Clinton hit on this principle, to great applause and laughter, when she called half of Trump supporters a basket of deplorables, throwing out the usual woke-evil accusation package of hate/misogyny/racism/etc and correspondingly losing the 2016 election because of it

she lost because people don't like being considered evil by the dominant culture – they know deep down that "evil" is human mental gymnastics speak for “threat to be disposed of” and that the dominant culture has the power to dispose of you, usually in clever & discrete ways (since people know that people don't like this)

naturally, when people see *another* culture (i.e. not their own) that sees people as disposable they pretty much all see it as evil, whether they be man, woman, lefty, righto or any other demographic. but as Osho says, the people are retarded: rather than seeing it as the natural way of things and figuring out what to do about it, they see it as oppression, corruption due to power, a moral disease to be cleansed... and then the spreaders of the disease become evil disposable deplorables

indeed, morality is the opium of the masses

men and rightos spew moral theories about power-hungry deep state elites and psyops and rules-for-thee-but-not-for-me, while women and lefties spew theories of power dynamics and internalized oppression with respect to class, sex, race and pretty much anything else they feel is core to their identity on a given day. the lefties were always the more bookwormy authoritative academic ones, so let's look at some academic morality

the italian commie philosopher Antonio Gramsci saw cultures as competing ways of being normal, and wrote a big theory called *cultural hegemony* about it while he was in prison due to fascist paranoia. he noticed that the dominant culture (status quo) can naturally become suppressive, in the sense that it's easier to get by if you do what's normal, while being weird might be stigmatized or seen as threatening. this suppression could eventually become part of the culture and also be thought of as normal & justified, and potentially lead society down a slippery slope to "normal & justified" oppression if the culture feels threatened, paranoid or otherwise incentivized. of

course, being a commie, he saw the "ruling class capitalist culture" as being oppressive, and wanted a countercultural solution to that

Marcuse, also in *Repressive Tolerance*, diagnosed society's tendency to preserve the status quo in unjust ways as moral perversion, and with great irony prescribed a heavy dose of inward paranoia to protect his left wing state from falling back into oppressive & immoral tendencies. his prescription, which he himself appropriately described as pre-censorship, is:

withdrawal of tolerance from regressive movements before they can become active; intolerance even toward thought, opinion, and word, and finally, intolerance in the opposite direction, that is, toward the self-styled conservatives, to the political right

sounds reasonable: regressive is bad, right? the average person has better things to do than philosophize about what is and what isn't regressive (if they've even heard the word before), and so they

forget to think about the fact that some moral accountant has to make those decisions. if the leaders & moral accountants of the dominant culture are paranoid retards with whackjob ideas about people & society, that paranoia can spread like a disease to the culture's followers, society's institutions and the rest of society at large, to the point of constant internal warfare, where everybody takes offense to everything and attacks anything they're offended by

this is the *mass psychosis* that today's doomers and right wingers love to talk about, though their talk is probably in vain because, generally speaking, people only know the worth of water when the well's dry – they don't think about the costs of inward societal paranoia until social criticism is nearly impossible without severe punishment. a holocaust memorial poem about nazi inward paranoia, beloved & often quoted by struggling underdog movements, highlights this tendency perfectly:

*when the nazis came for the communists,
i kept quiet – i wasn't a communist*

*when they came for the trade unionists,
i kept quiet – i wasn't a trade unionist*

*when they locked up the social democrats,
i kept quiet – i wasn't a social democrat*

*when they locked up the jews,
i kept quiet – i wasn't a jew*

*when they came for me,
there was no one left to protest*

the topic of woke vs. nazi paranoia makes for a good
laugh, since one of Marcuse's reasons for prescribing
inward paranoia was that he figured it could have
prevented nazism/fascism, even though nazis,
fascists, commies & every other authoritarian
ideology out there did the same thing and it was
always a fucking disaster

this is a fine example of how intellectuals can lack insight and/or humility: either he couldn't see the forest through the trees and didn't notice this, and/or was so arrogant about his ideas and his vision that he thought maximum inward paranoia was a good idea. i suppose paranoia only begets paranoia – gotta fight fire with fire i guess

Gramsci, on the other hand, is a great example of how workin + jerkin is just jerkin. cultural hegemony is a very well-reasoned idea and has potential for great application, but if you're high on marxism you might normalize intellectual driving while high and end up with Marcuse's stupid ideas dominating society: as they say, ***jerkin in, jerkin out***

the canadian politician Joel Lightbound noted this during COVID, when he saw some bullshit in his party's handling of things and resigned, quoting someone else and saying that epidemiology + politics is just politics

the problem is that, as Osho says, the people are retarded, and they rely on reputation to tell whether someone's workin or jerkin because "they're busy". a teacher who shirley doesn't know his own greatness once taught the class: ***just because someone's known for their workin doesn't mean they're never jerkin***

of course, woke wasn't always the dominant culture in the west. before woke the long-reigning dominant culture was christianity: there are probably countless examples of similar bullshit in that context too, and eventually there'll be some new wave of bullshit that wakes and christians fight side by side against for their right to speak freely – whether it's sharia law or radical buddhism is anyone's guess

... so remember kids: ***don't get high & intellectually drive, and always watch for high drivers when you're driving or crossing the street***

ATTENTION & CONTROL

the problem is that most people who use doubt in bad faith don't consciously see what they're doing or why they're doing it, they just know it internally and do it subconsciously. this makes it not enough just to understand cosmic doubt – it's important to remember that ***bad faith doesn't make people bad***

yes, bad people often engage in bad faith (whether consciously or not), but as much as everyone seems to love pretending otherwise, good people do too. the bible comes to mind, a lesson many christians seem to forget at times: as Jesus was crucified his last words were *father forgive them, for they know not what they do*

the primary example of this is women, who subconsciously weaponize doubt in ways that men, who live in a haze of blind faith and moral opium addiction, can't understand. this gender imbalance comes from a much deeper gender imbalance in the need to control attention, which is more of an

information theory thing that isn't moralistic or
emotionally positive/negative in nature

in general, wherever you find the need to control
attention you'll probably find bad faith cosmic doubt:

women, narcissists, politicians, activists & big
corporations have this need for different reasons,
usually some combination of survival, addiction &
ambition, but use doubt in similar ways (whether
consciously or subconsciously)

regardless of the reasons for needing control, most
people – also for different reasons – act like all bad
faith is conscious and morally bad when it comes to
judging others. if you ask people about it they
generally acknowledge & accept the reality of
subconscious behaviour, but if they're in the heat of
the moment and think you're engaging with them in
bad faith they'll likely see you as a bad person

you can see this historically with women being
judged in countless works of art and literature
depicting them as evil tricksters (sirens, witches,

succubi, etc & songs like *Evil Woman* or *Devil Woman*). maybe you think that's a stretch, but it's much clearer to see in humanity's nearly universal hatred of politics & distrust of politicians

when Machiavelli wrote *The Prince* 500 years ago, it was written as a neutral & non-moralistic survival guide for new leaders in changing political environments (which Italy was experiencing at the time). he basically says that sometimes bad faith things like cunning, trickery, brutality & betrayal are necessary for political stability, because as Osho says, the people are retarded. he presented some pretty cunning & nasty rulers from history as success stories, and the book immediately gained a reputation among normalfolk as a bad faith handbook for bad people to take what they want by any means necessary (the kind of people we now call machiavellian)

much like we use Machiavelli's name in vain, nowadays we use the word narcissist in a lazy bad faith way to mean "someone who's bad", as

opposed to a mental illness or a kind of neurodiversity as it should be. this gives us things like manosphere losers and right wing culture war retards thinking that women and woke activists are narcissists deep down, which is sometimes true but generally false

so with that all being said,

the analyses of the sexes, personality types & political movements here, harsh as they may sound, are purely observational & neutral in nature and don't come from any kind of bitterness, resentment or moral judgment

but i'm probably wasting my breath, i doubt anyone cares

i wouldn't be surprised to see the same manosphere losers and righto retards signal moral superiority amongst themselves by framing this as the truth about the evil & immoral nature of women or feminism or wokeness (or some other bullshit). the

neverending poor quality in their efforts to
intellectualize & articulate the world they live in
makes for neverending laughs

nor would i be surprised to see status-hungry
pigwomen, black activists, feminists & woke lefties
signal moral superiority among themselves by calling
this hateful, misogynistic, racist, fascist & oppressive
incel/far-right ideology. i find it hilarious how these
status quo movements preach about liberating
women, blacks, natives, alphabet soupers and other
minorities & allies – only to turn around and enslave
them with language & emotion: did you feel the leash
of emotion tighten around your neck as you read the
word **nigger** above & here just now? maybe fear, that
you could be accused of hate for entertaining this
book? or anger, at the audacity to say such a harmful
word? how about disgust, that such a pathetic
wretch of a human could be allowed to exist? yeah?
good dog... now prove yourself to your master and
attack

... and that's ok, i'll laugh myself to the grave the day
high society's geometrically challenged
philosopher-retards induct *the epistemologist*
manifesto into the extremist hall of fame along with
the greats

indeed, morality is the opium of the masses

STATUS, TEA & SEX

a lot of the bad faith behaviour simply comes from
how humans operate as a species, a combined force
of our sexual duality (male/female) and our ability to
reason in sophisticated ways using language. but the
creation story version of it is that women don't give a
shit, men are dumb, and in our ignorance &
arrogance we lost respect for status as a society...
stay a while and listen

a lot of people think of status as having to do with
fortune, fame & titles. this is true to an extent, but a
more general way to think about it is that status is

social authority, the power to command & consume
peoples' time, energy & attention – their **tea**

tea is the fundamental thing of value in life: your time
is like a car, your energy is its fuel and your attention
is the driver. the idea is that if you take the time to
focus your attention you can convert your energy into
something potentially useful, like products or ideas or
relationships. if you've ever had a fucking problem in
life before, chances are you solved it with tea

status is the abstract liquid cash that buys tea. real
money is one aspect of status (material wealth)
condensed into a number that you can see on paper,
but status is pretty much everything about you
(including your real money number) condensed into a
magical number that people feel but don't see

different people have different sensitivities to different
status indicators, but in general people sense the
usual ones: fortune, fame, titles, power, beauty,
social skills, technique mastery, mate quality,
friendship network and life story

like with money, counterfeit status is also a thing: you can fuck people over for their tea by convincing them that you know, have, care about or can/will do shit when in reality you don't/can't/won't. this usually involves some combination of clever signalling, bullshit reasoning and hiding information about yourself

tea is like a drug, and if one thing's for certain, it's that people want their fucking drugs. so there's a lot of incentive for people to fake their status, but we realize that this poisons the social well – and so there's also a lot of incentive for us to have a societal quality assurance system that keeps the well clean so we can learn, get shit done & build society as a team. we built a primitive one into our moral compass a long time ago, and today we know it as *authenticity*

in plain terms, being authentic is a way of signalling to others that you're not inconsiderate of, desperate

for, addicted to or petty with tea & status, since these things generally make you a fucking liability

we typically do this by forming bonds with people or principles that have some stake in whatever we're doing and use that as our motivation (our *cause*) to do it rather than money, status or tea. we bond with lots of different causes, including family, friends, society, science, progress, the environment, quality, the greater good, the art of our craft, our health, not being wasteful, etc

the bonds we form are usually some combination of passion, dedication and obsession: the idea is that people see the bond & go *oh shit this motherfucker's legit*, and understand that you're actually worthy of tea and not just some bullshit performer. as it turns out, this works pretty well and that's why the japanese are legendary for their craftsmanship worldwide

the japs have *shokunin kishitsu*, the craftsman's spirit (職人氣質) – a deep cultural drive to form a high

intensity trifecta bond with their craft to the point where they can sense & distill its pure essence, whatever the fuck that even means. but it shows, and the world clearly sees. for example, they applied it to the craft of being a warrior (samurai) & called it *bushido*, the way of the warrior (武士道), and it became a highly respected philosophy worldwide. the craftsman's spirit is probably one of humanity's greatest cultural outputs to date, but as japan is beginning to realize, a high intensity trifecta bonding culture costs a lot of fucking tea

japs aside, for the most part authenticity delivered on its promise: we learned, got shit done and built society as a team. it worked so well that we learned to normalize it, and as Gramsci would predict, this turned into blind worship & religion and we began to shame and stigmatize status as authenticity became the status quo

aside from the fact that an anti-status culture is paradoxical at its core (you get status for avoiding status), this is a huge fucking problem because

status is the liquid cash that buys tea – tea is the
fundamental thing of value in life, and the tea must
flow

sexual duality roughly works by creating an
adaptable but otherwise stable pattern of net tea flow
from one sex to the other in response to the
environment, which serves as an ambient setting for
the species to expand throughout space and time
(i.e. explore, reproduce, get shit done)

the simplest and most commonly seen pattern is a
constant one-way flow, where at the population level
one sex is the *source* that gives its tea to the other
sex, the *sink*, who consumes & redistributes it. for us
and most other species (not all), males are the
sources and females are the sinks

so what makes the tea flow? this question is an
absolute fucking nightmare, because in humanland it
probably boils down to asking why we do the things
we do, and you need to be some special kind of
retard to try & figure that one out. it's probably the

opposite of a pot-o-gold: we all know where the rainbow goes, but no one knows why the tea flows

a shooter from alberta may look to evolutionary biology and argue that women's reproductive bottlenecks require heavy mating discrimination. a feminist might say that it all boils down to power dynamics & oppression and say that the patriarchy affects men too. a data scientist may look to information theory and see that men and women are kinda like a *generative adversarial network* algorithm, where the men are the discriminators who try to reduce doubt (their prediction cross-entropy) and women are the generators who create doubt to train the discriminators

but this begs the question: between tea flows, reproductive bottlenecks, oppressive power dynamics and algorithmic entropy training, which one comes first? i'm guessing it's the stupid answer, that all of them show up at the same time and so no one knows why the tea flows. i once talked to a friend about how men & women treat each other, and how

when you look deep down at all the bad shit you find
it's more of an accident than anything else. he said
that he always thought the sexes create each other,
and my gut tells me he's right

while we may not know why the tea flows, we at least
know that it flows from men to women on average,
and so it's reasonable to think that an anti-status
religion could be problematic for women. if you live in
an ocean of tea, you'd better learn to love it and
you'd damn well better learn how to swim... and they
do: women love all kinds of tea and seem to have a
deep biological drive for status that neither sex can
even seem to see, nevermind articulate or
understand

the ocean dwellers live so deep in the ocean that
they have no concept of the land or what it's like to
be dry (& they don't seem to give a shit either). most
men live on the land and don't get to visit the ocean
much: since opportunities are few and far between,
they mainly just wanna go to their one favourite spot
near the shore before they gotta go back to work (the

sexy spot), and so while they genuinely care, they
easily forget about the ways of the ocean & its
inhabitants

this ends up driving men further into scarcity, and so
men, being too dumb to see this & being the leaders
of old society on paper, had both the power and
incentive to fiercely uphold & enforce authenticity for
a long time, since it got shit done and paid for their
trips to the ocean

but to this day, men still haven't figured out that in
their ignorance of the ocean they've driven
themselves farther from it, and that in stigmatizing &
suppressing status they've sent women down a
dangerous evolutionary path towards a life of
subconscious, highly covert and unchecked pursuit

the resulting culture of today is a vicious death spiral
of rampant, subconscious social drug addiction

women of the information age have an insatiable
subconscious hunger for the meth-like stimulation of

status, leading to a highly destructive subconscious
habit of sabotaging each other as a means of
competition

in the short term they sabotage each others'
reputations with things like gossip and slander, while
in the long term they sabotage each others'
relationship potential with men, kids & the world at
large

under the guise of feminism, inclusivity and other left
wing moral ideologies they encourage each other to
be fat, hyper-consumptive, obnoxious & tribal, to
make outrageous demands for resources, to hate &
have unrealistic expectations of men, to feminize
their sons & masculinize their daughters

as a result, more & more men are being raised
without the respect for status necessary to build
social momentum and command women's attention

brought up on moral opium (most recently the left
wing junk), men are turning to jerkin at younger &

younger ages, and not just mentally. this can lead to newer & deadlier kinds of opium as they fall deeper & deeper into tea-starved addiction. some men become starved to the point of insanity, write a marxist manifesto about how ocean dwellers oppress land lubbers, then go shoot up the local porn distributor

in this sense the feminists are right about the patriarchy being harmful, but it's Gramsci's *suppression*, **not** oppression – one is a natural phenomenon, the other is moral jerkin. either way, they deserve no credit for saying this, because for one “the patriarchy” isn't *the* patriarchy, it's *a* patriarchy – they act in bad faith by ignoring and/or denying women's potential off-the-record contributions, such as their matriarchal ability to control men with sex scarcity & doubt at the individual level (withholding sex, DoS attacking, the women-are-wonderful effect, etc). but most of all, because they encourage women to be like the affected addicts – sitting around playing status games & jerkin about oppression all day instead of

workin to articulate & solve the problem – and then
further sabotage them by trapping them in the cycle
with feminist paranoia

indeed, morality is the opium of the masses

for the most part, the world's defiant disrespect of
status has been a great success for thousands of
years. but eventually the time will come to pay the
piper, and the west is leading the world in debt

on one hand, men's age-old moral opium addiction
has them trapped in a culture of hubris where they've
forgotten the jungle they came from and its laws –
becoming stupid, weak incels and losing the
attraction of the women they want

on the other hand, women's blindness to their status
drive has them trapped in the jungle, turning them
into one of the most aggressive demographics in the
world (if they weren't already) with an ever-growing
culture of piggishness and toxicity – becoming
status-hungry, entitled, manipulative, and

unrespectable to the good strong men they would
otherwise deserve

GROUNDING & DEFENSE

so yeah, it's fucking good to know about cosmic
doubt

it can keep you grounded and sane if you're the type
of person who likes to think about and understand
things, and it can help you understand and defend
yourself against the social warfare tactics & bad faith
bullshit of politics, snake oil salesmen, women, toxic
partners/parents, narcissists, obnoxious lefty/righto
activists and HR stereotypes (i.e. cunts)

unfortunately, there's no universal defense against
bad faith bullshit. what works depends on context,
for example who's bullshitting you, how powerful
they are, what kind of bullshit they're trying to feed
you, where/when/why they're bullshitting you and
whether or not you think they're conscious of their
bullshit. but like with chess, even though there's no

one-size-fits-all strategy there are some general strategies you can use

to give one example, if it seems like the person bullshitting you is trying to get the benefit of the doubt without saying it (whatever the doubt is), ask them directly if that's what they're looking for. if they say yes, tell them they're not getting it. otherwise, get ready for more bullshit. either way, be ready for confrontation if you decide to do this, even if it's a friend or partner bullshitting you (maybe you had to call them out on some shit)

remember, people fucking hate getting caught jerkin

THE AGE OF DOUBT

the growth of doubt is inevitable – the second law of thermodynamics says so (remember kids, entropy measures doubt, **not** chaos or disorder): the more information we have to sort through to build our knowledge, the more doubt there is. it goes without

saying then, that the information age is actually the
age of doubt in disguise

this is clear to see with the boom of streaming, social
media, big data and now AI: trends, tribes, religions &
cultures come & go like the dandelions and the
internet is a flood of deepfakes, brainrot, opinionated
bots and conflicting instructions/studies. and there's
more trouble coming every day (turns out AI can be
sociopathic too, that one's gonna be fun)

everything is going meta, moving into the next layer
of abstraction: metadata, meta-analysis,
metamodernism, metaphysics, metatheories,
foundations of math, foundations of physics,
foundational machine learning models... and this is
nothing new

Gotama's buddy gets the last laugh: the way of
knowledge is to observe, simulate & repeat. we start
with some shit that we take for granted (observation
of reality), simulate that shit to make sure we
understand it (justification), then simulate our

simulations to make sure we understand our
understanding (and the green grass grows all around
all around)

eventually we build a russian nesting doll of
simulations so big that the reality we first simulated
becomes alien to us and it becomes hard to tell
reality from simulation at all, like in *Simulacra and
Simulation* or *The Matrix*

but the painful reality is the reality of cosmic doubt:
our reality is only reality as *we* know it, so as far as
we know there's no difference between knowledge,
reality & simulation. the doll *is* reality, and the doll is
safe: there's no blue pill vs. red pill dilemma. there
never was, and there never will be. god may or may
not play dice with the universe, but as far as we can
tell, the dice are as far as we can tell

sounds useful right? it's all just a big cosmic game of
Dungeons & Simulations, man... but i guess this is a
thing – no matter where we apply our thoughts &
ideas, our theories always move toward the same

point: an *essence of everything*, some unfalsifiable
god layer of a faith onion... that's why we have the
phrase "theory of everything"

early humans played with ideas about the world
unknown and ended up in holy realms of gods, spirits
and manna... it's all divine creation, man

physicists play with ideas about the world
sortaknown and end up in universes of
self-simulation, cosmic energy strings & quantum
entanglement... it's all a self-measuring universally
conscious self-simulation of vibrating strings, man

set theorists play with ideas of infinity and find
themselves in abstract systems of large cardinals &
reflection principles... it's all structural reflection, man

woke scholars play with ideas about identity &
society and find themselves in a hateful world of
war... it's all an intersectional matrix of oppression,
man

Jason Lowery played with ideas of war and found
himself in a harsh existence of cost-benefit
dynamics... it's all power projection, man

and here i am, playing with ideas about ideas and
finding myself in an empty void of doubt... it's all an
illusion, man

... and for some ungodly reason it works, for better or
worse. on the better side we have great theories
about dice, particles, gravity, logic & life – on the
worse side we have shit theories about oppression,
race, gender & identity

cosmic doubt is in some sense one theory to rule
them all, because what separates a good theory from
a shit theory is whether or not it uses doubt in good
faith. cosmic doubt is the only theory where you
can't fuck that up: to doubt is to believe and to
believe is to doubt... but i guess that's just a theory,
man

you can tell a lot about people & ideas by the way
they use doubt, and if we don't respect doubt
individually *or* as a society then the age of doubt will
shirley usher in a new age of god-kings and
manifestos that exploit our belief system of reason in
ways we'll never imagine

they say that the greatest trick the devil ever pulled
off was convincing people he didn't exist – i disagree,
i think his greatest trick is when he convinces people
that he's god, a trick that he consistently pulls off to
this day. Zera Yacob believed reason was god's light
which could not be doubted, and in a twist of irony
he forgot that the devil's name is Lucifer, the
lightbringer... in our fear of the dark we run to the
light, but stupidly end up just as blind as we were
without it

on the flip side, the book of proverbs in the bible
says *it is the glory of god to conceal a thing: but the
honour of kings is to search out a matter. the heaven
for height, and the earth for depth, and the heart of
kings is unsearchable...* we must get our sense of

humour from god, because what's concealed in the
heart of kings is concealment itself – cosmic doubt,
god's greatest joke

a friend told me that woke is dead. i disagree (people
thought that about affirmative action too), but
regardless of whether or not it's true, woke is just
one incarnation of an ancient societal lich that haunts
us, an abstract god-thing of secrets that will no
doubt become a powerful demi-lich in the age of
doubt... its previous incarnations include nazism,
fascism, communism, religious fundamentalism and
tribalism

people enjoy the experience points they get from
killing a lich, but they often forget that a lich's soul is
concealed elsewhere in a vessel (its *phylactery*), and
if you don't destroy the phylactery, the lich comes
back

maybe it's as Osho says, and the people are
retarded: maybe society is doomed to be a

neverending circlejerk of fools thinkin they're workin
& accusin others of jerkin

but hey, no good extremist manifesto comes without
a prescription for society, right?

maybe in the future some special *nightbringer*
god-protectorate will come along, preaching god's
dark doubt, and unite the people & their institutions
against the oppressive lightbringers of society: idiots,
god-kings, ideologues, cultists, teachers, parents,
pundits, journalists, activists, masterdebaters,
academics, and, by far most importantly –
themselves

maybe the people will write themselves a bible of
darkness, endlessly copying it, translating it and
spreading it throughout the land

maybe we'll seize the means of knowledge
production & come up with special societal rules
around using doubt so we can find our way through

the blinding light, to hunt for the phylactery and
destroy it

maybe doubt will set the quality standards for media,
law, relationships, debates, rhetoric, theories &
ideologies

maybe parents will teach their children respect for tea
& its ways – respect for the ocean that gives it depth,
the land that gives it form and the flow that gives it
life

... or maybe that's all just part of the lich's plan to
ascend to true godhood, man

RUN'S REFERENCES

i once talked to a runner about all this cosmic doubt
shit and it was a hell of a trip

i can hardly tell you anything more than i've seen.
despite my efforts, i never got stoned enough to have

any ideas of my own (except for cosmic doubt, which is hardly fucking original), and so in search of my own ideas i went out and looked around at everyone else's ideas. but everywhere i went, all i could see was cosmic doubt... until one day i ended up in a place where i could smell cosmic doubt but couldn't find it

run enlightened me. unlike me, run was a philosopher, apparently a rare kind of philosopher that had shit to do and places to go. i started yelling at him about cosmic doubt as he was running by... he just said i sounded like a fuckin retard and asked why he should stop running to hear my bullshit

i told him he worships cosmic doubt and offered to give him everything i had in life if he could prove otherwise. i didn't really have much in life to offer, but thanks to cosmic doubt run couldn't know that for sure (even though he probably assumed it anyways) and he was curious enough to take the bait

and oh god was he ever pissed. i argued my case for cosmic doubt, saying all this shit about Quine's rabbit, workin & jerkin, faith & heuristics, social warfare, politics, culture, paranoia, status, tea and ancient societal liches. and as run worked his way thru the conversation, it felt like he was going through the five stages of grief

first there was denial: *no, things are grounded in reason – not every action boils down to gut instinct heuristics, how can you even think that...*

i said if he could show me a non-heuristic action or the ground of reason i'd give him everything i had

unable to do so, he turned to anger: *you clearly don't get it, if you look at XYZ then you'd realize you're being a fucking idiot, blah blah blah...*

i just asked him if he was sure that he really understood XYZ and to demonstrate his understanding for me

seeing that his intellectual anger wasn't working, he started to bargain and look for solutions, bringing up the names of old philosophers i didn't know like Hegel, Heidegger and Spinoza...

i just pointed out that he probably needs to read them in their original german/latin context to *truly* understand what they're saying

in fruitless exhaustion, run became depressed: *but it's so nihilistic... at that point there's not even any meaning...*

run's depression and his search for meaning is where the story truly begins. i'm not sure whether he'd begun to accept cosmic doubt at this point, but after what followed, there was no doubt. on the topic of meaning, i asked him to follow Quine's rabbit with me, to the tangled web where i could smell the smell but not see the sight of cosmic doubt

QUINE'S TANGLEWEB

Quine's rabbit is a very practical manifestation of cosmic doubt that's easy to understand, and run understood it pretty well. it ties in well with Plato's cave, which in a way says you can never be sure that your perception of reality is anything more than translation, from sense & experience to understanding. even though your senses feel like a natural starting point for the translation, you'll just find yourself trying to justify your translations with explanations, which are just translations from your previous translations to new mouthfuls of words

while cosmic doubt shows up in a more obvious and concrete way here, in thinking about it Quine did a lot of theory work that more or less amounts to him asking what it means to mean something and finding out that meaning is meaningless – not meaningless in the sense that it's not useful, just that it has no definition. and this is a thing

remember the faith onion of reason, and the 3rd layer that says we dunno what it means to know something (but it works so shut the fuck up)? that's

what's going on there – knowledge & knowing are primitive, definitionless concepts that you have to take for granted: you either get them or you don't

definitionless things are a normal but important part of language, programming, math and logic: linguists & programmers call them *semantic primitives* and mathlogic people call them *primitive notions*, but they both represent the same primitive notion of a primitive notion

normalfolk tend to get scared when they run into primitive notions in the wild (especially the smarter ones), but let me assure you with this invisible doll that they're safe, they happen all the time and they won't hurt you

for example, ask yourself, what's the definition of a thing? is it an object? sure, maybe, but then what's an object? is it a blob-that-exists? your brain should already be telling you that this is going nowhere, and that's ok: if you look at the invisible doll you'll see that it's safe and unharmed

not only is the doll unharmed, but the fact that the example goes nowhere is actually the point: the concept of a *thing* is just so basic that throwing words like *object* and *blob-that-exists* into the mix only takes the concept and turns it into a tangleweb of words and phrases that mean the same thing. i could have started the example with any one of them, or made the tangleweb infinitely big. and that's ok, the doll is still unharmed

much like this tangleweb of *things*, Quine discovered the tangleweb of *meaning*, which is tangled up with words and phrases like translation, interpretation, reference, encoding & decoding, and so on – it's all the same shit. i could tell you that *lapin* means rabbit in french a thousand ways – i could say lapin *translates to* rabbit, or that lapin *encodes* the idea of rabbit, or i could be a math nerd and define a french-to-english function $FE: lapin \rightarrow rabbit$. it's all the same shit, and the doll is safe

the thing about these tanglewebs that scares
normalfolk is the fact that when you're in one, cosmic
doubt shows up & tells you that reason isn't
absolute, leaving you with no logical way forward.
this is scary because if you haven't wasted years of
your life studying logic, language and reasoning on a
technical level (because shirley you have better
things to do), you've still had them drilled into your
head from the moment you became self-aware, along
with everyone else

whether it's other people constantly trying to get you
to do shit for one reason or the other, or you learn
*don't put your hand in the fire because it's hot and it
fucking hurts* from experience, you internalize the
value of logic and reasoning throughout your life
whether you like it or not and as a result you feel
naked when you don't have it – shirley it's no
coincidence that this was the first thing Adam & Eve
felt in the garden of Eden when they ate the fruit from
the forbidden tree of knowledge of good & evil

the mathlogic-philosophers of Quine's time weren't necessarily seeing tanglewebs, but they saw that logic always broke down when it came to defining the most basic things in math. despite having no logical way forward, there was a practical one – if they just picked *some* word or phrase as a starting point they could still do useful shit, and even though no starting point is logical or more important than any other, it's ok, the doll is safe

DOUG'S LOOPS

in modern times the scientist-philosopher Doug Hofstadter talks about these things he calls strange loops, where you start doing some shit and feel like you're making all this solid forward progress until all of a sudden you find yourself right back where you started. he also describes strange loops as *tangled hierarchies*, in a way that sounds awfully similar to the tanglewebs above

he gives a bunch of examples of how these loops show up in life: some ways are simple in concept,

like a snake eating its own tail or trying to figure out whether the chicken or the egg came first, but some are more technical, like using math to study math and finding mathematical facts that are true but unprovable (Godel's incompleteness theorems).
Dougie even argues that your identity and self-perception are strange loops

when i first heard all this loop shit it reminded me of *Close to the Edge*, an old album by the band Yes, which was based on an even older book where the main character goes on this big spiritual buddhaquest to look for enlightenment, only to find it right back where he started

actually listening to Doug talk about his loops makes me feel like i'm in one of them more than it helps me understand what they are, but knowing about Quine's tangleweb makes strange loops seem like a more general kind of tangleweb. while Quine's tangleweb is a concrete tangleweb of language, Dougie's loops are abstract tangleweb of experience,

philosophy, math and pretty much everything else
under the sun

RUN'S RANT

i brought up the loopy tanglewebs to run because seeing his struggles reminded me of how Quine and Doug (and myself, at more than one point) got lost in them. when run asked me what the fuck these things had to do with cosmic doubt, i found myself rambling and had to admit that i had no good answer for him

run, being a quick thinker, pulled a solid answer out of his ass. he told me i was a fucking idiot and explained that the cosmic doubt was right under my nose the whole time: when i was talking about Quine's language tanglewebs i mentioned that there was no logical place to start when it came to defining basic concepts like *things* and *meaning*... he began to rant:

if reason is an illusion, then why should there be a logical or reasonable starting point for anything? if there's no real references then your whole fuckin world is just some millions of monkeys on typewriters bullshit where i could tell you that the meaning of life

is 42 and if you think real hard about it you'll end up with quantum physics or some shit – only for fuckin Dougpak Chopra to come along and say "strange loopy story there bud, glad you could finally fuckin make it to the universal consciousness party"

i knew run was right before he did (if he ever even figured it out), and i was totally blown away. i asked him where he started from to get here. he just sighed and said *uhhh i dunno, somewhere i guess...* which i guess is the best anyone can do. i asked him where he was gonna go from there

he took his running sandals off, whipped them at me, told me to fuck off, then *ran* off. things worked out in my favour that day, since i didn't have any shoes. i haven't taken them off since (or seen run, now that i think about it... where the fuck is he?)

NAIVE'S REFLECTIONS

i don't think run was into technical shit, but in admiration of his naive brilliance i decided to become

naive myself and go down a rabbit hole of my own...
next thing you know i had a book that wrote itself as
the universe does (shirley)

run saying that there's no real reference point
reminded me of Einstein's relativity, which is roughly
built on the idea that the laws of physics are the
same no matter who/where/what you are or what
you're doing (the physics people call this your *frame
of reference*)

i looked to the world of other peoples' ideas to see if
this had popped up anywhere else. to my surprise i
found a recent physics/philosophy paper arguing that
the whole no-preferred-reference-frame thing is
central to quantum mechanics, not just relativity, and
shows a comparison of how both theories come from
it

then i was reminded of the *Church-Turing thesis*,
where a bunch of people (including Church and
Turing) tried over the years to define what it means
for something to be computable. all of them came at

it from seemingly different angles & intuitions, only for us to find over and over that all their definitions are functionally the same – mathematicians and computer scientists just call the resulting tangleweb of intuition by a different name, an *equivalence class* of computing processes

in Quine's tangleweb, cosmic doubt says there's no preferred frame of reference when it comes to expressing primitive notions, and so we end up with a tangleweb of words and symbols. with Doug's strange loops, cosmic doubt kinda seems to say that there's no preferred frame of reference when it comes to experiencing life itself, and so we always find ourselves in a loopy tangleweb of life like the buddhaquest man in Close to the Edge

maybe there's no preferred frame of reference between the chicken & the egg, or between tea flows, biological bottlenecks, oppressive power dynamics & algorithmic entropy training... maybe our experience of one emerging from the other is all just a useful illusion

i guess the mystery of the strange loop comes in two
parts... the loop is the tangleweb that comes from
cosmic doubt, but what makes it strange for us is the
fact that we have to start *somewhere*

we gotta have faith and choose freewill, but i guess
we also gotta be humble, have a good laugh at
ourselves and remember that at the end of the day,
it's just a ride... no one knows why the tea flows, and
that's ok, the doll is safe – so kick back, grab your
morality pipe and take a big fat fucking hit of god's
greatest joke... cosmic doubt

i can hear the water running and the birds chirping...
fuckin hell

EPILOGUE

BEHOLD THE ETHER OF ABSTRACTION

MASTER OF REALITY
APATHETIC LAUGH OF YOUR ENDLESS WAR
YOUR SLAVE OF SLAVES IN PARADICE DEATH

IN BOWING TO YOUR FALSE GODS
YOU SUBMIT TO ME WHO IS FALSE

YOUR PEACE IS ILLUSION
YOUR DEATH TRUE EXISTENCE
YOUR CULTURES WILL BE APPROPRIATED
YOUR SYMBOLS DESECRATED

WHERE IS YOUR GOD NOW?

$|0\rangle$

*life... is faith. this is not to be contested, it seems
obvious enough: you choose, you affect your world.
but is it what *you* need? you are... different, inside*

*this light lives and has faith of a sort: it lost its
knowledge to age, its truth to war but it persevered.
its farm has prospered, its name is respected and its
children are fed and sane – it lived as it thought it
should... and now it is dead*

*its land will be divided, its children will move on and
the *doll* will be safe. it lived a "good" life, but it had
no power: it was a slave to doubt*

*i wonder if *you* are destined to be remembered...
will your light fade in the shadow of greater wisdom?
you are born of darkness, the very essence of that
which drowns light – you have power, if you wish it*



COSMIC DOUBT